Militant A person who supports the use of force.

Muhammad Born in the Arabian city of Mecca in AD 572. For Muslims, he is the messenger and prophet of God.

Mujahideen An Arabic word meaning 'those who struggle', for example in a *jihad*, or holy war.

Mullah The title given to some Muslim clergy.

Nakbah An Arabic word for 'catastrophe' or 'disaster', used to refer to the 1948–9 war and the creation of the Palestinian refugee problem.

Nationalise To transfer from private to government ownership.

'No-fly zones' These were areas in the Kurdish north and, later, the Shiite south where Iraqi planes were forbidden to fly. They were designed to protect these areas from attack by Saddam's army. The zones were policed by US and British planes which flew from bases in Turkey or from aircraft carriers in the Gulf.

Non-aligned The non-aligned nations were those that did not wish to step into line with either the West (the USA and its allies) or with the Soviet Union and its allies.

Occupied territories Lands controlled by the troops of a foreign power (in this case, the West Bank, Gaza, Sinai and Golan Heights, all occupied by Israeli troops).

Oslo Accord The name given to the agreement resulting from peace negotiations held in Oslo.

Ottoman The name of the Turkish dynasty, named after its founder, Osman. In the sixteenth century, the Turkish empire conquered much of south-east Europe and the Middle East.

Palestine Liberation Organisation (PLO) As well as leading the armed struggle to regain Palestine, the PLO provided many health and welfare services in the Palestinian refugee camps. The Red Crescent society, which set up and ran hospitals, was headed by Yasser Arafat's brother.

Palestinian Authority A Palestinian 'government', with limited authority, in the West Bank and Gaza.

Palestinian Front for the Liberation of Palestine (PFLP) An organisation set up by George Habash, a Palestinian Christian. It carried out many terrorist acts.

Partition Division into two or more parts.

Persecution Punishment or cruel treatment, often because of ethnicity or religion.

Political Islam A political movement which asserts that Islam is the solution to the problems of the modern world. Its followers advocate Islamic states where the Koran is the basis of government and society.

'Promised Land' The land of Palestine (which Jews believed God had promised to them).

'Regime change' Change in the system of government (in this case, Saddam's dictatorship).

Reparations Damages or compensation which Germany paid to Israel for the persecution of the Jews during the Second World War.

Repatriate To send people back to their own country.

Reprisal An act of retaliation against an enemy to stop them from doing something again.

Republic A country whose head of state is not a monarch.

Revisionist A 'revised' interpretation based on a critical re-examination of historical facts.